SOOWER

Newsletter

# From the Chairman's Desk

Volume 2, Issue 3, September 2026

***Hope in Action: Education | Empowerment | Partnership | Impact***

Dear Donors, Partners and Friends,

The third quarter brought meaningful progress for SOOWER Foundation as we continued to advance our mission of restoring hope and transforming lives.

A major milestone was the launch of our Donate A Dream (DAD) Project, which welcomed seven Pioneer Scholars into the programme. The scholars, orphans from Christ Foundation Orphanage and Widows Outreach, have begun their secondary education as Junior Secondary School (JSS) 1 students at KNOSK 100 Naira-A-Day School, with their educational expenses sponsored by SOOWER Foundation. This milestone reflects our commitment to reducing financial barriers to education and expanding opportunities for vulnerable children.

We also strengthened our community impact through strategic partnerships. In Zaria, Kaduna State, we supported Excellence Ministry of Grace (EMOG)'s 19th anniversary celebration, which brought together widows and orphans for fellowship and encouragement. Through our partnership with Regy and Henry Amazing Grace Foundation (RHAGF), we also provided educational support for 29 orphans under Phase II of its Slum to School Initiative.

Beyond programme implementation, SOOWER participated in the Federal Ministry of Women Affairs and Social Development's 26th National Council on Women Affairs, Child Advancement and Social Development. This engagement provided an opportunity to connect with key stakeholders and strengthen our understanding of national social development priorities. We remain committed to sound governance, transparency and accountability as we continue to strengthen our institutional capacity.

These achievements were made possible by the commitment of our staff and volunteers and the continued trust of our donors, partners and other stakeholders. We are grateful for your support and for the shared commitment that enables us to reach vulnerable individuals and communities.

As we enter the final quarter of 2026, our priority is to build on this progress, strengthen our programmes and partnerships, and deliver sustainable interventions that respond to the needs of the communities we serve.

On behalf of the Board and Management of SOOWER Foundation, thank you for being part of this journey. Your support enables us to turn our commitment into practical action and meaningful opportunities for those who need them most.

Warm regards,

**Engr. Jonathan Agwunobi, FNSE**
Chairman & Co-Founder, SOOWER Foundation

# Impact at a Glance

## SOOWER's Impact (July 2026 – September 2026)

| | |
|---|---|
| **7 Pioneer DAD Scholars** | Inducted into the Donate A Dream (DAD) Project to begin their secondary school education. |
| **141 widows supported** | Continued monthly support throughout Q3 2026. |
| **31 missionaries supported** | Continued monthly support for missionaries serving their communities throughout Q3 2026. |
| **1 Federal Government Engagement** | Participation in the 26th National Council on Women Affairs, Child Advancement and Social Development. |
| **Partnership with Excellence Ministry of Grace (EMOG)** | Contributed to an anniversary celebration that reached 200 widows and 150 orphans. |
| **Partnership with Regy and Henry Amazing Grace Foundation (RHAGF)** | Supported 29 orphans through the Phase II Slum to School Educational Support Programme. |

# Celebrating Hope and Community with Excellence Ministry of Grace

As part of our commitment to supporting vulnerable families, SOOWER Foundation supported the annual Excellence Ministry of Grace Anniversary Celebration in Zaria, Kaduna State, on August 5, 2026. This year marked the Ministry's 19th anniversary, and the annual gathering brought together 200 widows and 150 orphans for a time of worship, fellowship, encouragement, and celebration.

With SOOWER Foundation's support, orphans received customised polo shirts, widows received wrappers, and participants were served lunch. The gathering brought visible joy and renewed hope to those in attendance, with participants expressing gratitude and renewed determination to face life's challenges.

The activity reinforced an important part of SOOWER Foundation's mission: supporting people not only with material assistance, but also with encouragement, dignity, community and hope.








# Engaging at the National Level

## 26th National Council on Women Affairs, Child Advancement and Social Development



From August 9 – 14, 2026, SOOWER Foundation participated in the 26th National Council on Women Affairs, Child Advancement and Social Development, hosted by the Government of Taraba State and convened by the Federal Ministry of Women Affairs and Social Development.

Held under the theme “Strengthening Families and Advancing the Care Economy for Inclusive Development: Operationalising Nigeria’s Renewed Social Protection Architecture,” the Council brought together government representatives, civil society organisations, development partners, women’s groups and other stakeholders to discuss priorities affecting women, children, families and vulnerable communities across Nigeria.



Key discussions focused on strengthening social protection and family support systems, advancing women's economic empowerment, improving child protection, promoting disability inclusion, and increasing women's participation in leadership and governance. The Council also emphasised stronger data, accountability, and collaboration among government, civil society, and development partners to ensure policies translate into meaningful impact at the community level.




For SOOWER, the Council provided a valuable opportunity to learn, engage with key stakeholders and contribute to national conversations on issues closely aligned with our mission. Our participation reinforces our commitment to strengthening partnerships and ensuring that our programmes remain responsive to the needs of the vulnerable communities we serve.

# Supporting Vulnerable Children Through Education

On September 9, 2026, SOOWER Foundation partnered with the Regy and Henry Amazing Grace Foundation (RHAGF) during the second phase of its annual Slum to School Programme at Piwoyi LEA Primary and Government Secondary Schools, Abuja.

The programme reached over 100 vulnerable children, with SOOWER Foundation providing educational support for 29 orphans. Each child received support covering school fees, uniforms, school bags, books and other essential learning materials.

Beyond meeting immediate educational needs, the intervention helps reduce the financial barriers that can prevent vulnerable children from enrolling in or remaining in school. By supporting their education, SOOWER is helping create opportunities for these children to learn, grow and build a more hopeful future. The programme also brought together community leaders, school authorities, civil society organisations and development partners, highlighting the importance of collaboration and community involvement in expanding access to education.

For SOOWER Foundation, this partnership reflects our commitment to ensuring that vulnerable children are not left behind simply because their families cannot afford the cost of education. Every child deserves the opportunity to learn, grow and dream – and we remain committed to helping make that opportunity possible.









# Giving a Child a Dream. Giving a Future a Chance.




**Seven Children. One Shared Dream. A New Beginning.**

**SOOWER Foundation celebrates the induction of its seven Pioneer Donate A Dream (DAD) Scholars.**

On September 28, 2026, seven children took an important step towards a future filled with new possibilities.
For these children, the opportunity to continue their education beyond primary school was not guaranteed. Although they had met the academic requirements to progress to secondary school, financial barriers threatened to stand in their way.

Through SOOWER Foundation's Donate A Dream (DAD) Project, that uncertainty has given way to opportunity.
The seven children, selected from Christ Foundation Orphanage and Widows Outreach, have become the first beneficiaries of the DAD Scholarship Programme. They have commenced their secondary education as Junior Secondary School (JSS) 1 students at KNOSK 100 Naira-A-Day School, with SOOWER Foundation sponsoring their educational expenses.

They celebrated their induction at the DAD 2026 Pioneer Scholarship Award and Induction Ceremony, held under the theme “Giving a Child a Dream, Giving a Future a Chance.”

The occasion brought together SOOWER Foundation, KNOSK 100 Naira-A-Day School, Christ Foundation Orphanage and Widows Outreach, government representatives, partners and supporters to celebrate a milestone that marked more than the beginning of a new school year. It marked the beginning of a commitment to seven young lives.





## A Dream Begins with an Opportunity

At the heart of the DAD Project is a simple but powerful conviction: a child's circumstances should not limit their potential.

For many vulnerable children, the transition from primary to secondary education can be uncertain, particularly when financial constraints make continued schooling difficult. The DAD Project was established to help bridge this gap by providing educational opportunities for orphans who demonstrate academic potential but lack the financial support to continue their education.

In her welcome address, SOOWER Foundation Executive Director Prof. Imelda Udoh emphasised that the Foundation's vision extends beyond providing scholarships. She explained that DAD is designed to promote educational equity, academic excellence, and character development, nurturing young people equipped not only with knowledge but also with the values needed to become responsible, compassionate, and productive members of society. Addressing the Pioneer Scholars, she reminded them that receiving a scholarship comes with both opportunity and responsibility. She encouraged them to study diligently, embrace discipline, respect their teachers and classmates, and remain resilient in the face of challenges. Her message also reflected the Foundation's long-term vision for the programme: “Today, you are receiving. Tomorrow, you should be giving.”

It was a reminder that the impact of DAD should not end with the seven children receiving support today. The hope is that, as they grow and succeed, they will also become people who create opportunities for others.

## Beyond School Fees: Investing in Their Future

Introducing the project, SOOWER Foundation's Head of Programs, Ms. Ogba Abah, shared the vision behind DAD and the Foundation's commitment to removing barriers that prevent vulnerable children from accessing quality secondary education. She explained that the Foundation selected the seven Pioneer Scholars through a screening and assessment process that considered academic performance and vulnerability status, with orphanhood as a key eligibility criterion. Having met the requirements to proceed to secondary school but lacking sponsorship, the children were given an opportunity to continue their education through the Foundation's intervention.

The DAD scholarship provides comprehensive educational support, covering tuition, uniforms, textbooks, stationery, meals four times a week, and sanitary care for female scholars. The estimated annual sponsorship cost is ₦1,350,000 per scholar, equivalent to ₦450,000 per term. However, SOOWER Foundation's commitment goes beyond meeting the financial cost of education.

To ensure that the scholarship translates into meaningful educational progress, the Foundation will work closely with the school and caregivers to monitor each scholar's academic performance, attendance, class progression, personal development and overall wellbeing. Through termly academic reports, individual performance tracking, review meetings, welfare check-ins and annual assessments, SOOWER Foundation aims to identify challenges early and provide the support needed to help the children remain in school and progress towards completing their secondary education.

For SOOWER Foundation, the goal is not simply to enrol seven children in school. It is to support them throughout their educational journey and give them a stronger foundation for the future.

## DAD at a Glance

**7**
Pioneer DAD Scholars

**1**
Partner Secondary School

**3**
Core Partner Organisations

**₦1.35m**
Estimated Annual Sponsorship per Scholar

**6 years**
Intended Duration of Secondary Education Support

**1**
Shared Goal - Helping Every Scholar Complete Secondary Education

### Your Past Does Not Define Your Future

One of the memorable moments of the ceremony was the inspiring charge delivered by the Guest Speaker, Mrs. Etima Umeh. Congratulating the Pioneer Seven, she shared ten important lessons to guide them as they begin this new chapter.



Her message centred on gratitude, resilience, discipline and the value of education. She encouraged the scholars to embrace learning as a powerful tool for creating opportunities and reminded them that their past experiences need not determine what they can achieve. She also challenged them to learn from their mistakes, see setbacks as opportunities for growth, and appreciate the teachers, caregivers and mentors who contribute to their development.

Above all, she urged them to believe in their ability to build a different future. Her message was clear: Your circumstances today do not have to determine your tomorrow.




Representatives of Christ Foundation Orphanage and Widows Outreach and KNOSK 100 Naira-A-Day School reinforced the importance of education, discipline and the collective responsibility of supporting the scholars.

Pst. Regina Nuhu, a member of the SOOWER Board, also encouraged the children to recognise their worth and make the most of the opportunity before them.




**Seven Children. One Shared Dream.**

One of the most significant moments of the ceremony came when the seven scholars were introduced and presented with their DAD Scholarship Awards and Scholar Starter Packs. One by one, they stepped forward to receive the awards that formally recognised them as the Pioneer DAD Scholars. But beyond the certificates, school materials and applause lay something far more meaningful: a promise of sustained support.



Through the partnership between SOOWER Foundation, KNOSK 100 Naira-A-Day School, and Christ Foundation Orphanage and Widows Outreach, the children have a network of institutions committed to supporting their education, welfare and personal development. Each partner contributes to the children's journey, ensuring they receive more than financial assistance as they navigate the years ahead.



SOOWER Foundation's Board Chair and Co-Founder, Engr. Jonathan Agwunobi, reaffirmed the Foundation's commitment to supporting the scholars throughout their secondary education. He encouraged the children to stay focused on their studies and thanked the project partners for their contributions in making the initiative possible.




Speaking on behalf of the Pioneer Seven, Destiny Bawa expressed heartfelt appreciation to SOOWER Foundation and its partners for the opportunity to continue their education. His response reminded everyone what the ceremony truly represented: seven children beginning their secondary school journey with the support of people and institutions committed to helping them succeed.

The scholars subsequently took the DAD Scholars' Pledge and were formally inducted into the programme, marking the beginning of their responsibilities and commitments as scholarship beneficiaries.

## More Than a Scholarship, a Community of Support

The launch of the DAD Project also celebrated what can be achieved when individuals and institutions come together around a shared purpose.

Partners and supporters attended the ceremony, including representatives of the Federal Ministry of Women Affairs and Social Development, Regy and Henry Amazing Grace Foundation, Army of God Gospel Outreach, KAFTAN TV, Betharbel Foundation and TRT Arredo.

Their presence reflected the importance of collaboration in expanding educational opportunities for vulnerable children.

For SOOWER Foundation, the DAD Project represents a long-term investment in the potential of children who deserve the opportunity to learn, grow and pursue their aspirations.

As the Pioneer Seven progress through secondary school, the Foundation will continue to work with KNOSK 100 Naira-A-Day School and Christ Foundation Orphanage and Widows Outreach to monitor their progress, support their wellbeing and celebrate their achievements.

The journey ahead will require dedication from the scholars, sustained commitment from SOOWER and its partners, and the continued support of those who believe in the transformative power of education.

But on September 28, 2026, that journey began with seven children and a shared commitment to their future. The DAD Project is giving these seven children more than access to education. It is giving them a dream to pursue, a community to believe in them, and a future to look forward to.

Sometimes, giving a child a dream is the first step towards giving them a future.



# Challenges, Lessons Learned & Next Steps

### Challenge

The initially identified candidates did not meet the school's admission requirements, and no reserve candidates had been identified.

### Lesson learned

Scholarship selection needs to begin earlier, with sufficient time for screening, school assessments and admission processes.

### Action for the next cycle

For subsequent scholarship cycles, SOOWER Foundation will begin candidate identification and screening ahead of school admission periods and maintain a pool of eligible reserve candidates. This will allow sufficient time for assessments, admission processes and contingency planning.

### Looking ahead: Our commitment

As we enter the final quarter of 2026, SOOWER Foundation will focus on strengthening programme delivery, monitoring the progress of the children we support, and improving the systems that underpin our work. We will continue to learn from implementation, respond to community needs and build partnerships that help us deliver responsible and sustainable support.

We thank our donors, partners, volunteers and supporters for making this work possible. Your continued commitment helps us expand opportunities for vulnerable individuals and families.

# Be Part of the Next Chapter

The stories in this newsletter represent real children, families, and individuals whose lives are changing through support, partnership, and opportunity. But there is still more to do. You can help SOOWER reach more people by:

- **Donating** to support monthly stipends, education, healthcare, and emergency relief. Donations can be made to any of our accounts:

  NAIRA ACCOUNT

  **Account Number:** 1307460869
  **Account Name:** SOOWER Widows & Missions Foundation
  **Bank Name:** Providus Bank

  NAIRA ACCOUNT

  **Account Number:** 2045534702
  **Account Name:** SOOWER Widows & Missions Foundation
  **Bank Name:** First Bank of Nigeria

  DOLLAR ACCOUNT

  **Account Number:** 2045605299
  **Account Name:** SOOWER Widows & Missions Foundation
  **Bank Name:** First Bank of Nigeria

- **Partnering** with us as an organization or faith-based institution.
- **Volunteering** your time, skills, or professional expertise.
- **Advocating** by sharing our mission and amplifying the voices of the vulnerable.
- **Praying** with and for the communities we serve.

For partnership and support, please connect with SOOWER Foundation through our official channels.


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**SOOWER Widows and Missions Foundation**

*Perfectly positioned to lend a helping hand!*